

Unit Student Learning Outcomes (SLOs)

- Locate on a map the early civilizations (Indus Valley, Sumerian, Mesopotamia and Egypt).
- Explain why all the early civilizations began in river valleys.
- Identify the key cities of the Indus Valley Civilization.
- Locate on a map the main towns/cities of the Indus Valley Civilization.
- Describe life in the Indus Valley Civilization (e.g. work people did, crops they grew, food they ate, clothes and jewelry they wore, the games they played).
- Give examples of the influence of the natural environment on the way of life in the Indus Valley Civilization.
- Describe the art, architecture and science of the Indus Valley Civilization.
- Describe the impact and significance of the development of writing in the Indus Valley Civilization.
- Describe the architecture of Indus Valley Civilization.
- Describe the organization of the city of Moen -jo- Daro (Citadel and the lower town).
- Describe a home in Moen- jo- Daro.
- Compare the town planning and architecture of the Indus Valley Civilization with the present day concept of good town planning.
- Interpret the religious belief system of Indus Valley Civilization with the help of artifacts found there.
- Describe how the towns and cities of the Indus Valley Civilization were governed (political structure, military organization).
- Describe the tools and technologies used in the Indus Valley Civilization (e.g. animal and crop domestication, irrigation, weapons, transportation).
- Describe trade within Indus Valley Civilization and with foreign lands providing evidence for the same.
- Identifying trading activities of Indus Valley Civilization with reference to their exchange of goods and items with other civilizations.
- State the different reasons for the decline of Indus Valley Civilization providing support for the same.
- Explain with the help of examples the continuity and change in different features of culture of the people of Indus Valley Civilization and people today.
- Describe the historical significance of early societies (e.g. Adaptation for survival, enduring human aspirations, the origins of social and political structures).
- Identify the ways early society helps us understand contemporary society.

Introduction to the Unit

Most of the ancient civilizations have been found near river valleys because of the following reasons such as, rivers provide ample water for irrigation in agriculture, the soils along the river banks are very fertile, the rivers provide fish for food, rivers provide means of transport and communication, rivers contribute to increase in trade and commerce, rivers help in the movement of people and therefore to the spread of knowledge and movement of ideas. No wonder, the ancient civilization of Egypt flourished on the bank of the River Nile, that of Mesopotamia on the banks of the rivers Euphrates and Tigris, the Chinese on the bank of the great Yellow river and the ancient Indus Valley Civilization on the bank of the River Indus. This unit will focus on the Indus Valley Civilization (3500-1500 BCE).

CHAPTER 1: THE LAND AND PEOPLE OF THE INDUS VALLEY CIVILIZATION

SLOs

- Locate on a map the early civilizations (Indus Valley, Sumerian, Mesopotamia and Egypt).
- Explain why all the early civilizations began in river valleys.
- Identify the key cities of the IVC.
- Locate on a map the main towns/cities of the IVC.
- Describe life in the IVC (e.g. work people did, crops they grew, food they ate, clothes and jewelry they wore, the games they played).
- Give examples of the influence of the natural environment on the way of life in the IVC.
- Interpret the religious belief system of Indus Valley civilization with the help of artifacts found there.
- Describe how the towns and cities of the IVC were governed (political structure, military organisation).

Introduction

The Indus Valley Civilization grew from villages scattered throughout the Indus River Valley. It existed between 3300 -1300 BCE. It flourished between 2600–1900 BCE. There were a large number of cities and towns, but the center of power was the city of Harappa.



The cities of Harappa and Moen-jo-Daro were laid out on an essentially rectangular grid, with wide streets. The cities were divided into large walled neighbourhoods, with narrow lanes separating the rows of houses.

We know little about the people and their way of life, as the writing of the people of the Indus Valley Civilization has not yet been deciphered. All we came to know from the study of the artifacts uncovered. No one knows what caused the end of this civilization.

The Land and life in Indus Valley Civilization

The Indus Valley Civilization extended over most of Pakistan, parts of North-West India and North-East Afghanistan covering an area of 1.25

million sq km. Till today, more than 1,000 cities, towns and settlements have been found, mainly in the region of the Indus River which gives this civilization its name. The big cities were Harappa and Moen-jo-Daro. There were lots of smaller cities, such as Lothal, Dholavira, Kalibangan and Banawali. The names of these cities were given to them in later times. We do not know what the people of the Indus Valley Civilization themselves called these cities.

Activity:

- Locate the Indus Valley Civilization on an archeological map of South Asia.
- Locate on a map the main cities of the Indus Valley Civilization on a map of Pakistan.



Archeological Map of Indus Valley Civilization

The land was very fertile due to the silt left by the flooding of the Indus River. Farmers cultivated big fields using their wooden ploughs pulled by oxen. They grew food crops such as wheat, barley, peas and beans and fruit such as dates, grapes and melons. They probably also grew cotton. They kept cattle, sheep, goats and chickens for food. Cows and Buffalos provided them with milk and meat and their skins were used for making leather. Bullocks were used to pull carts and to pull the plough.

It is believed that at its peak, the Indus Valley Civilization had a population of more than five million people.

Structure of Houses

The houses were made of sun-dried or baked bricks. Some houses had just one room. Big houses had lots of rooms arranged around a central courtyard. Some big houses were of two or three floors. Stairs led to the upper floors and roofs. The inside walls were covered with mud plaster. There were no windows onto the main street. This kept out dust and noise. Side windows let in light and air. The thick walls kept people cool in the heat of summer.

Some houses had private wells for clean water, others had shared wells. Houses often had two kitchens, an outside kitchen for the summer and an inside kitchen for the winter. Most city houses had a bathroom and a toilet connected to the city drains. Waste water drained out of the house into the street-drains.

Activity:

- Draw a house you imagine must have existed during the period of the Indus Valley Civilization.
- Explain how it is different from the house you live in today.

Historians believe that cleanliness was an important aspect of life in the Indus Valley Civilization. This conclusion is based on the following items of evidence:

- The houses had easy access to water.
- The city had an excellent drainage system.
- Dustbins were placed at convenient points for the people to throw garbage and other waste materials.

Occupations

Most city dwellers were traders or artisans. Some workers made stone querns (for grinding grain to make flour). Others spun and wove cotton into cloth. Yet others made beads, fishing nets, pots and baskets. People made bullock carts to travel by land and boats of woods with a sail to travel by sea. The people who lived in towns and villages farmed the land and raised animals.

Dressing Patterns

There are only a few stone figures and a few pictures of seals that show us how the people of the Indus Valley Civilization dressed. They show that men wore a cloth around the waist, resembling a modern dhoti. The so called "Priest-king" and other stone figures also show men wearing a long robe over the left shoulder. Some male figures are shown wearing a turban. Women wore knee-length skirts. The clothes were most likely made of cotton cloth, woolen textiles from Mesopotamia and skins of animals for cold weather.

Both men and women wore jewelry. Men wore bead necklaces and bangles; and women wore bangles, earrings, rings, anklets and necklaces. Some women also had elegant hairstyles and head dresses.

Toys and Games

There is very little known about the children in the Indus Valley Civilization. Children's toys have been found among the artifacts. These include tiny carts with clay wheels, a variety of animal figures and dices.

Activity:

- Look at the artifacts below. What kind of games do you think the children of Indus Valley Civilizations played? How are their games similar or different to the games we play today?



Wheeled Ram



Dice



Zebu Bull

Religious Belief System

We have very little information about the religious life of the people of the Indus Valley Civilizations. The stone statues, terracotta figurines and seals provide some clues.

Pictures of seals show what look like figures of gods. A seal picture shows a male god with horns and three faces. Around him are animals, including an elephant, tiger, rhino and buffalo. This god is a bit like the Hindu god Shiva (who also has three faces).



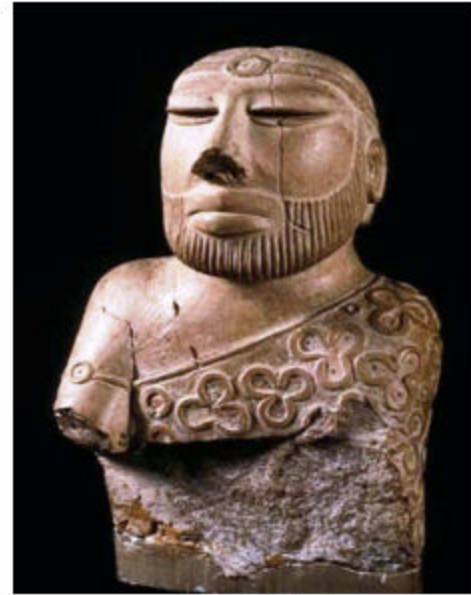
Activity:

- Look at the pictures given below. Which according to you could possibly tell us something about the religion of the people of the Indus Valley Civilization? Give reasons for your answer.



Another figure looks like a Mother goddess. The large number of female figurines also point to a Mother Goddess. People probably believed this goddess gave health and fertility to people, animals and plants.

A small stone statue of the 'Priest-King' found at Moen-jo-Daro shows the head of a man with a beard and headband. He is wearing a robe with a three-leaf pattern on it. He looks like an important person; probably the head of the people (King) or a religious leader (Priest). He has worn a piece of cloth which is similar to the present day Ajrak in terms of shape, design and style.



King Priest

In the earlier phases of their culture, the Indus people buried their dead; later, they also cremated them and buried the ashes in burial urns.

Authority and Governance

There is no concrete evidence to indicate the centre of power in the Indus Valley Civilization. However, it can be assumed that the king priest exercised the power and authority and he took the decision on important matters.

Now, we knew that Indus Valley Civilizations flourished along the banks of the River Indus over 5000 years ago. They had a fertile land due to the availability of water and agriculture and trade was common among the people. The people were skilled in different professions and crafts. We know very little about the governance and religious system of the people. We cannot say for certain whether there were kings or rulers to rule over them like in the other civilizations or they ruled themselves.

SUMMARY

The Indus Valley Civilization extended over most of Pakistan, North East Afghanistan and North-West India covering an area of 1.25 million sq km. It grew from small farming villages scattered throughout the Indus river valley. The civilization began around 3300 BCE and ended around 1300 BCE. It flourished between 2600 BCE and 1900 BCE. The cities of Harappa and Moen-jodaro were surrounded by thick walls with towers and gateways but their use is not known. The cities were well planned; houses were well built and had a supply of clean water and a drainage system. Artifacts discovered reveals the professions people had, the way they dressed and the toys children played with. There is very little information about government or the religious life of the people of the Indus Civilization. This is because the writing has not yet been deciphered.

END OF CHAPTER EXERCISE

A. Check Your Knowledge and Understanding

1. Fill in the Blanks

- i. The Indus Valley Civilization grew along the bank of the _____.
- ii. The civilization existed between _____ and _____ BCE.
- iii. The two main cities of the Indus Valley Civilization are _____ and _____.
- iv. Our knowledge of the people and their way of life comes from studying the _____ that have been unearthed.
- v. Children's toys include _____ and _____.

2. Match the artifacts of Column A with the description in Column B

Column A	Column B
Dancing girl	Round, deep dishes used for eating purposes.
Seals	Coloured cubes with a different number of holes on each side.
Bowl	A huge, one horned animal carved on seals.
Bull	A bronze statuette of a young girl in a pose.
Dice	Small square stones with drawings on them, used by traders for trading purposes.

3. Answer the Following Questions

- i. In which Continent and near which river did the Indus Valley Civilization develop?
- ii. Name two famous cities of the Indus Valley Civilization and state where they are located.
- iii. In which mountain range does the river Indus begin?
- iv. To which age does the Indus Valley Civilization belong?
- v. What are the main sources of our knowledge about the Indus Valley Civilization?
- vi. What were the occupations of the people of the Indus Valley Civilization?

B. Use Your Inquiry/Investigation Skills

1. Find out about the city of Moen-jo-Daro. Then prepare a one page flyer using both words and pictures to encourage people to visit this historical place.

C. Cooperate With Others

1. Working together in a group and make a model of a Moen-jo-Daro house.

CHAPTER 2: ART AND ARCHITECTURE OF THE INDUS VALLEY CIVILIZATION

SLOs

- Describe the art, architecture and science of the Indus Valley Civilization.
- Describe the impact and significance of the development of writing in the Indus Valley Civilization.
- Describe the architecture of Indus Valley Civilization.
- Describe the organisation of the city of Moen-jo-Daro (Citadel and the lower town).
- Describe a life-style of people in Moen-jo-Daro.
- Compare the town planning and architecture of Indus Valley Civilization with the present day concept of good town planning.

Introduction

In the first chapter of this unit, we have learnt about the land and people of the Indus Valley Civilization. In this chapter, we will learn about the art and architecture of the Indus Valley Civilization. The cities of Harappa and Moen-jo-Daro are among the earliest examples of city planning. The city was planned in a grid-like pattern. There were broad streets with drains laid along them to make a highly developed drainage system.

Town Planning and Architecture

Most important features of the Indus Valley Civilization are town planning and architecture. The cities of the Indus Valley Civilization were very well planned. Each city was planned in a grid-like pattern, formed by straight roads, running from North to South and East to West. This divided the city into blocks. The main streets were almost 10 meters wide, so two bullock carts could pass by each other. Rows of houses were built on both sides of the streets and drains were laid along

Interesting Facts:

- All Indus Valley bricks were the same ratio of 1: 2 : 4 but came in different sizes. A common size was 7 cm high 14 cm wide x 28 cm long.
- Bricks were laid in rows, end to end and crossways, using wet mud as cement to stick the bricks together.

the streets. The ancient systems of sewerage and drainage that were developed and used in cities throughout the Indus Valley Civilization were far more advanced than any found today in the Middle East and more efficient than those in many areas of Pakistan and India today.

Activity:

- Look at the picture below. It shows you an Ariel view taken from high up in the air of Moen-jo-Daro. Discuss about the technical skills of engineers and artisans. Match the standards of their work with the modern standards of town planning.



An Ariel view of Moen-jo-Daro City

The houses were built of thick walls of baked bricks. The bricks were joined together with mud, gypsum and lime mortar. The inside walls were covered with mud plaster. There were one room houses, houses with several rooms which opened onto a courtyard and houses were two to three floors high. Stairs led to the upper floors and roofs. There were no



windows facing the main street. This kept out dust and noise. Side windows let in light and air. The houses were spacious and airy and allowed the sunlight into them. The thick walls kept the houses cool during the summer. All houses had bathrooms which were connected to the drains on the side of the streets. Some houses had their own wells



for water while others had shared a well. The architecture of the Indus Valley Civilization was very advanced. There were well-designed dockyards, well-built granaries, large warehouses, well aligned brick platforms, and impenetrable protective walls. The massive walls of Indus cities most likely protected them from floods and invaders.

Activity:

- The Facilities are listed in a column A. Complete the Column B by inserting information about Moen-jo-Daro and your area.

Column: A	Column: B	
Facilities	Moen-jo-Daro	My Area
City plan	Grid like	
Roads	Straight, paved	
Access to water		
Drainage		
Garbage cans		

- What have you learned from filling in the table above? Discuss with a class fellow.
- Would you like your area to be more like Moen-jo-Daro? Why or why not?

Moen-jo-Daro's Great Bath

The Great Bath in the city of Moen-jo-Daro looks like a swimming pool. Like all other structures, it is made of baked brick, but here the bricks are joined together with tar and gypsum. It is over 14 meters long and seven meters wide. It has a brick-paved courtyard and columns on three sides. Two sets of steps lead down into the bath.



Great Bath Moen-jo-Daro

Water (probably from a well) filled the Bath to about 2.4 meters deep (a human beings is about 1.8 meters). Water was drained out through one corner into a drain.

Water, it seems, was very important to the people of the Indus Valley Civilization and it may have had some religious significance. The Great Bath, many believe was a place where religious ceremonies were held.



The Art of Indus Valley Civilizations

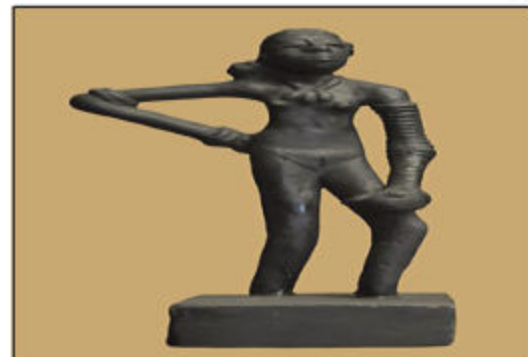
The Indus Valley Civilization left no temples or tombs and no great statues of kings or gods. However, various sculptures, seals, pottery, gold jewellery and detailed figurines in terracotta (clay baked at high temperatures to make it hard and waterproof), bronze and steatite (soft stone hardened when fired in a kiln) have been found at excavation sites. These give us some idea of the art of the Indus Valley Civilization.



An old well in Lothal

Sculpture

Various sculptures of people and animals made from terracotta, stone and metal have been found. One figure is the Priest-King, with his beard and his



patterned robe. Other figurines of girl in dancing poses show the presence of some dance forms in the Indus Valley Civilization. There are also terracotta figurines of cows, bears, monkeys and dogs.

Pottery

The people of the Indus Valley Civilization used bowls, dishes and cups made of terracotta. The clay pots were shaped on a potter's wheel. Most pots are plain, but some pots are decorated with bands, patterns of leaves and flowers and shapes like fish scales. A few pots were colored blue, red, green and yellow.



Jewellery Making

Archeologists have found evidence that the people of the Indus Valley Civilization wore lots of jewellery, especially necklaces, bangles and earrings. The jewellery was made of clay and soapstone beads and shells. At Harappa, archaeologists found the grave of a man, who was buried wearing a necklace of more than 300 soapstone beads.



Dance and Music

Figurines of dancing girl indicate that the people of the Indus Valley Civilization engaged in some form of dancing. A harp-like instrument depicted on an Indus seal and two shell objects found at Lethal indicate the use of stringed musical instruments.



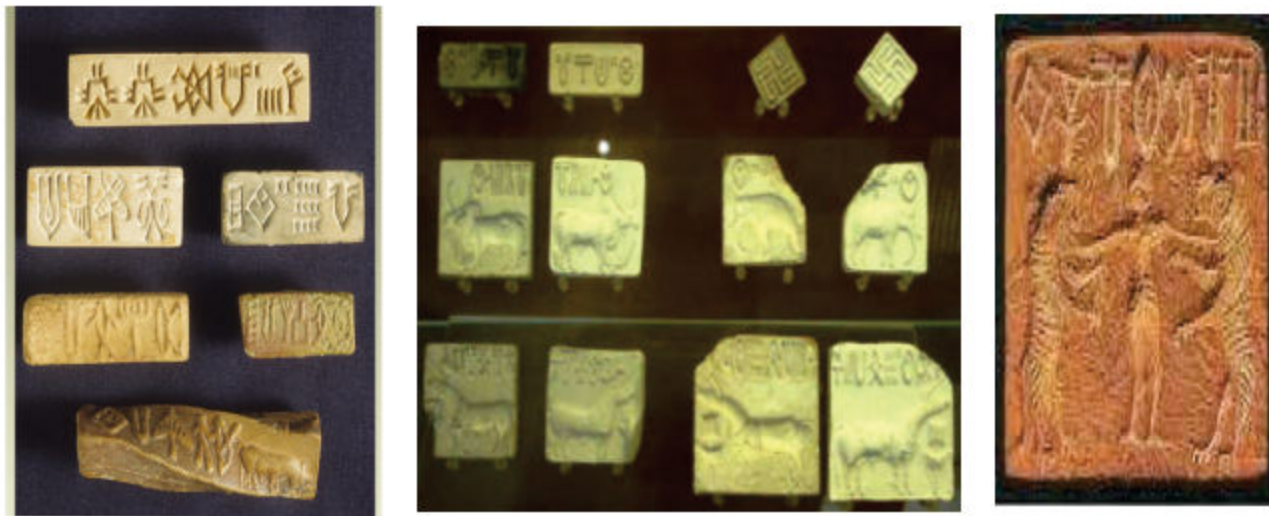
Writing

No one knows what language the Indus people spoke and no one has yet been able to read their writing. There are no books and no laws carved in stone; but there are



many writings on the seals found. The writing used picture signs or characters (not letters of the alphabet as in English, Urdu and Sindhi). At least 400 different characters have been identified. The longest bit of writing found has only 26 characters.

People wrote using a pointed stick on soft clay. They also used a sharp tool to write and etch on stone or metal. People wrote the first line from right to left, the second line from left to right, and so on. With such few writing samples available, it is likely that only a few people could read and write. It appears that most of the writing probably had to do with trade. Therefore, traders could probably read enough to tell what was written on seals.



Activity:

- In modern English, we start each new line on the left. Can you find any other modern writing that is done differently?

It can be concluded that the people of the Indus Valley Civilization were skilled in art, architecture and science. It is amazing to know that 5000 years ago, there was a civilization which was so advanced in not only town planning and architecture, but also in art, language and science. Archaeologists today are greatly surprised at the skills, expertise and a planning vision of the people of the Indus Valley Civilization.

SUMMARY

The people of the Indus Valley Civilization living over 5000 years ago were skilled in town planning and architecture. The town planning and architecture of the Indus Valley Civilization is much better than some present day civilizations. The art of the people of the Indus Valley Civilization can be seen in their sculpture, pottery, jewellery. There is also evidence of some form of dance and music. Buttons made from seashell were used in the Indus Valley Civilization for ornamental purposes by 2000 BCE. The Indus Civilization had a writing system, but all attempts to decipher it have failed. Examples of the writing system have been found on pottery and seals.

END OF CHAPTER EXERCISES

A. Check Your Knowledge and Understanding

1. Fill in the Blanks

- i. The people of the Indus Valley Civilization were good in _____ and _____.
- ii. Houses and other buildings were made of _____.
- iii. Three forms of art in the Indus Valley Civilization were _____, _____ and _____.
- iv. We know that the people engaged in some form of dancing because a statuette of a _____ was found.
- v. Seals with writing on them were used for trading. This shows that the traders could _____.

2. The Artifacts are given in Column A. Match Column A with Column B

Column A	Column B
The bust of a Priest-King	Dance
Figurines of dancing girls	Music
Stringed instruments	Pottery
A terracotta bowl	Stone sculpture
Seal with picture signs	Writing

3. Answer the Following Questions

- i. How were cities planned in the Indus Valley Civilization?
- ii. Describe the houses the people of the Indus Valley Civilization lived in?
- iii. List all the kinds of art the people of the Indus Valley Civilization practiced. Draw one artifact that shows this art form.

B. Use Your Inquiry/Investigation Skills

1. Find out about the art and architecture of one other civilization (Ancient Egypt and Mesopotamia) that existed at the same time as the IVC.

C. Cooperate With Others

1. Working together in a small group, prepare a poster showing the different forms of art, of the Indus Valley Civilization and the same form of art today.
2. Display the poster on a display board for everyone in the school to see and learn.

CHAPTER 3: TOOLS, TECHNOLOGIES, SCIENCE AND TRADE

SLOs

- Describe the tools and technologies used in the Indus Valley Civilization (e.g. animal and crop domestication, irrigation, weapons, transportation).
- Describe trade within an Indus Valley Civilization and with foreign lands providing evidence for the same.
- Identifying trading activities of Indus Valley Civilization with reference to their exchange of goods and items with other civilizations.

Introduction

In this chapter, you will study about the tools, technology and science of the people of the Indus Civilization. The people of the Indus Valley Civilization used some tools like the ones we use today, such as hammers, chisels, needles, fishhooks, axes, razors and saws. They made many of their tools from stone called flint. They also made tools of copper and bronze. Trade was important and a number of artifacts found indicate that the people of the Indus Valley Civilization traded with a lot of other countries both near and far.

Tools

The people of the Indus Valley Civilization used many of the tools we use today, such as chisels, axes, and saws. Many of their tools were made of stone. They also developed some new techniques in metallurgy and produced copper, bronze, lead and tin. They made tools from these metals as well.

Science and Technology

The people of the Indus Valley Civilization were among the first to develop a system of uniform weights and measures to accurately measure length, mass, and time.

1. Rulers made from Ivory were in use by people in the Indus Valley Civilization. In Lothal one such ruler has been found. The ruler is

divided into units corresponding to 33.5 mm and these are marked out in decimal subdivisions with amazing accuracy. Ancient bricks found throughout the region has dimensions that correspond to these units.

2. Weights were based on units of 0.05, 0.1, 0.2, 0.5, 1, 2, 5, 10, 20, 50, 100, 200, and 500, with each unit weighing approximately 28 grams, similar to the English ounce or Greek *unci*.
3. Unique Harappa inventions include an instrument which was used to measure whole sections of the horizon and the tidal dock.

Activity:

- Working in pairs, make a poster of the tools, weapons and technology of the Indus Valley Civilization. Ensure that there is equal distribution of work. Respect each other's opinion.

Tools	Weapons	Technology

Trade

The economy of the cities of the Indus Valley Civilization depended on trade. Internally, farmers brought food into the cities. City workers made such things as pots, beads and cotton clothes. Traders brought the materials workers needed, and took away finished goods to trade in other cities. Traders usually walked, carrying their goods on their back. They followed the river, walking along its banks.

Indus Valley traders did not use money as there is no evidence of this. They probably exchanged goods, such as selling two sacks of wheat for one basket of minerals.

The traders weighed their goods on weighing scales, using stone

cubes as weights. The weights were made from cubes of a flinty rock called grey chart. The smallest cube was very light, weighing less than 1 gram and the heaviest was over 11 kilograms.

Trade was facilitated by major advancement in transport technology. The Indus Valley Civilization may have been the first civilization to use wheeled transport such as bullock carts as well as boats driven by a sail (similar to those seen in Pakistan today). Traders could put large quantities of their goods on wooden carts pulled by bullocks. Boats allowed traders to not only carry large quantities of goods but also to travel further distances in shorter periods of time.

External trade goods included terracotta pots, beads, gold and silver, coloured gem stones such as turquoise and lapis Lazuli, metals, flints (for making stone tools), seashells and pearls. Traders brought Minerals from Iran and Afghanistan, Lead and copper from India, Jade from China and cedar tree wood was floated down the rivers from Kashmir and the Himalayas.

We also know that Indus Valley traders traded with Mesopotamia because Indus seals have been found there. To reach Mesopotamia, Indus ships sailed west. They probably kept close to land. A bit of old Indus pottery found on beaches in Oman, in the Gulf, is evidence of this.

It can be concluded that the Indus Valley people were advanced in trade and travel. As no evidence of money was found for either internal or external trade, it is presumed that trade was carried out through boats and carts and that seals were used as replacements of money. The people of Indus Valley Civilization were advanced in science and technology that achieved great accuracy in measuring length, mass and time. They were the first to develop a system of uniform weights and measures. Other than this, they were skilled in developing tools for different occupations.

SUMMARY

The people of Indus Valley Civilization used some tools like the ones we use today, such as hammers, knives, needles, fishhooks, axes, razors and saws. People made bullock carts to travel by land. Archaeologists have found clay models of carts, which look like the bullock-carts still seen in India and Pakistan today. Boats of wood with a sail were made to travel on the water. These boats are similar to the ones we see floating down the river Indus today. Artifacts discovered shows that the Indus Valley cities lived by trade. Traders traded their goods carrying them on their backs and walking along the river, loading them onto bullock carts or boats to take them quickly over land and sea. Trade goods included terracotta pots, beads, gold and silver, colored gem stones such as turquoise and lapis lazuli, metals, flints (for making stone tools), seashells and pearls. Indus Valley traders did not use money. They traded one set of goods for another.

END OF CHAPTER EXERCISE

A. Check Your Knowledge and Understanding

1. Fill in the Blanks

- i. A system of measurement was developed to measure _____, _____, and _____.
- ii. Most tools were made of _____.
- iii. New techniques of metallurgy resulted in the development of _____ and _____.
- iv. The economy of the Indus Valley Civilization depended on _____.
- v. Trade with other places was facilitated by the development of _____ and _____.

2. **Make a Table** to show the goods that were traded (bought and sold) by the people of the Indus Valley Civilization.

3. Answer the Following Questions

- i. What tools were used by the people of the Indus Valley Civilization, for each tool, mention one thing it was most likely used for?
- ii. Describe the technology used to measure weight.
- iii. What technology facilitated trade with other places?
- iv. How do we know that the people of the Indus Valley traded with other places?

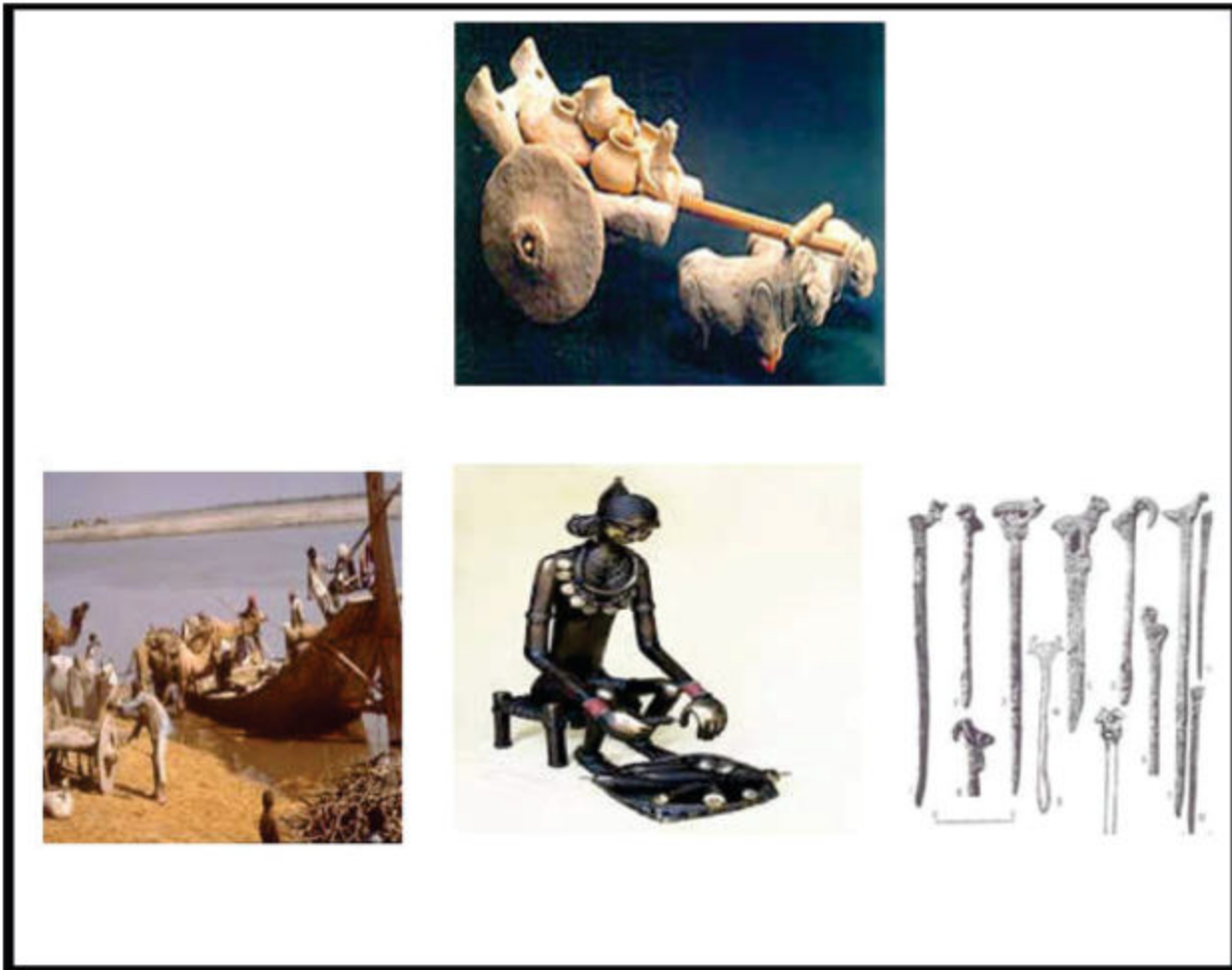
B. Use Your Inquiry/Investigation Skills

1. Look at the pictures given below. What do you think they were used for?



C. Cooperate With Others

1. Working together in a small group, develop a pictorial booklet on the Indus Valley Civilization. Below each picture, write a caption that describes the picture.



CHAPTER 4: THE END OF THE INDUS VALLEY CIVILIZATION

SLOs

- State the different reasons for the decline of Indus Valley Civilization providing support for the same.
- Explain with the help of examples the continuity and change in different features of culture of the people of the Indus Valley Civilization and people today.
- Describe the historical significance of early societies (e.g. Adaptation for survival, enduring human aspirations, the origins of social and political structures).
- Identify the ways early society helps us understand contemporary society.

Introduction

The Indus Valley Civilization began from around 3300 BCE. It grew, developed and became a great civilization between 2600 and 1900 BCE. From 1900 to 1300 BCE, this civilization started to decline and finally ended. The aim of this chapter is to highlight the causes of decline of Indus Valley Civilization.

What Happened to the Indus Valley Civilization?

Till today, we do not know why the Indus Valley Civilization came to an end. There is no reliable source from which to find the answer. Historians, however, think that the decline may have been caused by one of the following:

- It was commonly believed that the Aryans were the next people to settle in this area. They were skilled fighters, so an attack by them may have led to the destruction of the Indus Valley Civilization. Poems in the Rig Veda describe the victory over cities in the Indus Valley. Thirty-nine human skeletons discovered during the excavation of Moen-jo-Daro pointed to some violent cause of their death. But most historians do not believe this theory as there is no evidence of war or mass killings.
- Historians now believe that a natural disaster such as floods may have been responsible. Floods forced the people to leave their houses. The houses were rebuilt, but with broken bricks and no proper

drainage system. Most of the cities in the Indus Valley Civilization have been found in a condition as if these had been first abandoned and then rebuilt.

- It has been found that around 2000 BCE major climatic changes occurred in the Indus Valley. There was a fall in the average rainfall due to shifts in the monsoon pattern and changes in temperature (hotter) that led to desert-like conditions. This led to the decline in agriculture on which most of the trade was dependent. Owing to this, people of the Indus Valley started relocating to some other location leading to the decline of the entire civilization. The location where the Indus valley civilization once flourished is a desert today.

Importance of the Indus Valley Civilization

The people of the Indus Valley Civilization did not leave great structures, like the Pyramids of Egypt or the Great Wall of China. All that remains of their cities are the ruins we see today. However, many of the elements of the Indus Valley Civilization are seen in later cultures and even in cultures in Pakistan and India today. In rural areas, people still make bricks and bake them in kilns. These bricks are used to build houses and beautiful buildings.

The people of the Indus Valley Civilization showed us the importance of cleanliness. To ensure clean water for all, there were public wells. They had a good sewerage and drainage system that took waste and deposited it in sewer pits outside the city walls.

In their clean, well-run cities, the people of the Indus Valley Civilization engaged in a variety of arts and crafts. They used different materials and tools to make utensils for daily use, jewellery for men and women and toys for the children. They often decorated them with designs using flowers, leaves or fish scales. The Ochre colored pottery of the Indus Valley Civilization is still made in the whole region today. The Indus people's gift to the world was showing how to live in peace in cities. There is little evidence of weapons or of an army in the Indus Valley Civilization.

There is evidence that some of the beliefs and practices of Hinduism began here. There is evidence that the people of the Indus Valley Civilization changed from burying their dead to cremating them, a practice dominant in Hinduism today.

SUMMARY

Till today, we do not know why the Indus Valley Civilization came to an end around 1300 BCE. The Indus Valley Civilization is important for many reasons: town planning and architecture, the importance attached to cleanliness, the variety of arts and crafts that are still common in the region in which this civilization existed and most importantly the need for people to live in peace with each other.

END OF CHAPTER EXERCISE

A. Check Your Knowledge and Understanding

1. Fill in the Blanks

- i. The Indus Valley Civilization came to an end around _____.
- ii. Historians have not been able to find the cause that resulted in the Civilization coming to an _____.
- iii. Three reasons why the Indus Valley Civilization is important for us are _____, _____, and _____.

2. Make a Table to show each suggestion for the end of the Indus Valley Civilization and the evidence historians have for each.

3. Answer the Following Questions

- i. Explain the importance of the Indus Valley Civilization.
- ii. What two things that you have learnt about the Indus Valley Civilization, if implemented in your city or town would help improve it.

B. Use Your Inquiry/Investigation Skills

1. Find out about the things that are helping your city/town to flourish.

C. Cooperate With Other

1. Working together in a small group of four, identify what can be done to make your city/town well-known in the country.

END OF UNIT EXERCISE

A. Check Your Knowledge and Understanding

1. Match the Artifacts given in Column A to its use in Column B

Column A	Column B
Baked bricks	Build houses
Beads	Carry goods from one place to another
Carts	Eat food
Dishes	Make jewellery
Figures of animals	Measure length
Needles	Measure weight of items
Ruler	Play with
Seals	Sew clothes
Weighing scale	Trade

2. Answer the Following Questions

- Locate the Indus Valley Civilization and two other Civilizations that existed at that time on a map of the world?
- What factors do you think helped the Indus Valley Civilization grow and develop?
- Describe the work the people of the Indus Valley Civilization engaged in. For each type of work list the tools used.
- What were the reasons for the decline of the Indus Valley Civilization?
- How did the Indus Valley Civilization influence later civilizations?
- What aspects of the Indus Valley Civilization are still in evidence today in Pakistan and India?

B. Use Your Inquiry/Investigation Skills

- Role play in pairs, one student being from the past and one from the present. Discuss the points below in an oral interaction:

2. Compare the culture and way of life of the Indus Valley Civilization and of Pakistan today using the headings given below. Provide reasons for your answer.

- Food
- Clothing
- Occupations
- Architecture
- Art
- Tools
- Government
- Religion
- Role of women and men in society

C. Communicate With Others

1. Imagine you are living in the Indus Valley. Draw a picture of your house by the river on one side of the post card. On the other side, invite your friend to come and live with you in the river valley. Tell your friend the advantages of living by the river.

D. Cooperate With Others

1. Working together in groups of four, develop a 1 page report on the Indus Valley Civilization. The report should include the following information.
- A Map showing the location of the Indus Valley Civilization.
 - The culture of the people: food, dress, housing, arts and crafts, religion and government.
 - Trade, how it was conducted, what goods were bought and sold within and what was the nature of external trade.
 - Use each character in the writing to stand for a word in English/Urdu/Sindhi and then write a paragraph.
 - Explain how the civilization declined.
 - What aspects of the culture of IVC do we see today in Pakistan and India?

E. Be Creative

1. Make a toy using materials including clay, leather, etc.

F. Become Technologically Smart

1. Write an email to your relative or friend living abroad telling them about two most fascinating things that you have learnt about the Indus Valley civilization.
2. Launch a campaign with your school mates and teachers for the preservation of Moen-jo-Daro. Develop an e-petition. Invite your friends, family, schoolmates and others to sign the e-petition. Once you have 50 signatures, send it to the department whose task it is to protect and preserve the archaeological site of Moen- jo-Daro.

G. Become a Responsible and Active Member of Society

1. You have come to know through the media that the archaeological site of Moen- jo- Daro is not being properly looked after by the concerned department. Now that you know so much about the Indus Valley civilization, write a letter to the Minister for Culture, Government of Sindh, asking the Minister to preserve the city of Moen-jo-Daro. Give at least three reasons why the Minister should do so.
2. Write a letter to a Television channel asking them to do a programme on the Indus Valley civilization. Give them three reasons why they should do so.